

OREGON CITY COURIER.

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M. J. BROWN,

EDITOR

AN EASTERN VIEW.

(New York Journal).

The great number of Americans that had the pleasure of meeting Governor West of Oregon during his recent trip throughout the country with the other governors of the northwest were impressed by him as a man modern in thought, kind in heart and shrewd in truly advanced GOOD ideas. Of those that met him not one will be surprised to learn that he has taken a firm stand against that form of murder, impersonal and general, but MURDER NONE THE LESS, which is called capital punishment.

The state of Oregon, setting an excellent example to the rest of the country, will vote this year upon the abolition of capital punishment.

And Governor West, expressing the best sentiment of the best men in the state, acts without delay and announces that exercising his power as governor he will permit no official killings between this date and next December, when the people will then have decided the question by their ballots.

It is unfortunate that there should be any man bitter, revengeful and primitive and savage enough to believe that the murder by the government of men that have committed murder can be called now necessary, useful and executable.

We all know the great power of example.

The father that would cure his boy of lying must not lie in the hearing of that child.

The father that would discourage brutality and vice in his children must not himself be brutal and vicious or hope to excuse himself on the ground that his authority permits that which is forbidden to childhood.

And the state that does not wish its citizens to commit murder in anger for revenge or on any pretext must not itself be guilty on any pretext of committing an official murder.

Capital punishment is brutal, degrading; it encourages murder and does not discourage it.

Men that mean well will tell you that if you stop punishing murder with murder, if you cease to do to the murderer what he has done to his victim, you will make life insecure and murder more frequent.

But that is not so.

Murder, thieving and every other feature of degraded human life depend not upon savage laws, but upon intelligent, conscientious national character accompanying benevolent government.

There is no capital punishment in Switzerland under any circumstances.

And in America, in proportion to the population, we have at least ten times as many murders as they have in Switzerland, where there is no guillotine, no electric chair and no hangman's noose.

A witty Frenchman defended capital punishment by saying: "If the murderers don't want capital punishment, let them give it up themselves. Let them stop killing."

A mother's kindness teaches children to be kind. Government, decency and kindness will set a higher standard even among the lowest.

Capital punishment should be abolished.

Oregon and Governor West are to be congratulated.

Postmaster General Hitchcock is working himself out of a job as fast as he can. His latest brood, without consulting with the white house, is the recommendation that the government buy and own the telegraph lines of this country. This, following his disclosure of not carrying grafts and recommendation of parcels post, puts him in bad with the Republican administration and his head will fall in the basket as soon as the standard-bearers dare work the knife.

The dispatches state that Hitchcock's announcement "agitated official Washington greatly," and when official Washington is roused to this point something usually happens to the agitator.

People will read of the tortures and savage rites of the self-scorchers of New Mexico and ask "Can such things be?" Last Saturday the state prison in Wilmington, Del., two men were tied to posts, stripped to the hips, exposed to the zero weather, and then publicly whipped with cat-of-nine tails until the blood ran down their backs and filled their shoes. The news dispatches relate that the heavy leather strap with its nine thongs, cut deep into the quivering flesh of the wretches.

Now let us take up another collection for foreign missions that the savagery of Africa and China may be stopped.

Ben Selling says Oregon is strong for Taft. Ben needs a council of doctors.

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We want the small account and have every facility for handling the large one. Start the new year by opening an account at this bank

THE BANK OF OREGON CITY

The Oldest Bank in the County

THE MATTER WITH OREGON

Under your editorial of "What's wrong with Oregon?" I'd like to take a few exceptions. You assert "there is too much dead land." That can be bought for a dozen times what its tax value is. Don't you know that the law makes it the duty of the assessor to place a true cash value on this land? Still it does not matter whether he does or not so long as each particular tract is given a valuation in conformity with those of adjoining tracts.

The trouble with Oregon lies mainly in the fact that we're spending a lot of money foolishly and with little or no return for the money spent. You don't have to go far, Mr. Editor, to see this.

Careful estimates have placed the dead or waste land of this county at about one fourth. I don't mean lands owned by Weyerhaeuser or others who own timber lands, though much of this land will not and never can be cultivated. Clackamas county extends to the summit of the Cascade mountains and every person who has given this matter much attention knows that there is much dead land that is of no value whatever except for the timber growing upon it.

"Ask the first dozen men you meet what they think of Oregon's system of taxation, and if they are honest they will tell you that it is equal to the leprosy to keep settlers out."

Now, friend Brown, that's putting it pretty strong. Don't you know very well that the Oregon system does not differ very materially from those of the other states? Every taxpayer knows, or ought to know, that but a few years ago every county was required to make a levy of five mills for school purposes. This made a fund of about \$2.75 per capita for children of school age. We got along fairly well then, too, as everybody knows. Now we are required to pay \$8.00 per capita and they are not satisfied yet. I don't know how many useless commissions the state may have to provide for the hungry hordes, but they are not going to save one cent on W. A. Dineen's raised his voice to object. Now if the Oregon system is so bad, why are so many leaving other states to come here? The remedy is plain, and that is, choke them off. It is much easier to spend money than it is to save it as we all have learned.

"It is a dead certainty that if adopted by the voters there will be a life of dead land brought to life and settlement in this state. I have yet to hear this disputed and I want to tell you that when you settle Oregon's great wastes you won't have to hunt for business and prosperity." Now that sounds nice on paper, but I am not going to believe it. It is a dead certainty that anything like it, if it did it'd be with one thing. To my mind it will bring anything but good results. Just now the farmers of Oregon are doing as well as they ever were in its history and they are certainly paying their share of the burden.

"It can't make conditions worse and it is bound to make them better, for it will force Wall Street out and give the poor man a show."

"Give the poor man a show." That is pretty nice bait to hand out to the unwary; but surely they are not all suckers.

Give the poor man a show say I, too; but, God bless you, who ever thought of such a thing? You don't tell me that "Force Wall Street out" isn't that too bad? Where is the poor homesteader to get off? Get off the earth, or fence. When a rich man is taxed so that he has to give up his holdings you rest assured that the poor homesteader has surrendered before.

What does all this lead to? Right underneath it all they are working for the government ownership of the land. Why not be honest with the people and come out in the open and fight?

In conclusion let me say that I am an admirer of your editorials, for have found them instructive and pleasant reading, and I am satisfied that when you give this subject careful study and get down to the unadorned, you will change your opinion and be wise.

E. C. HACKETT.

1. The fact that we are spending too much money—if it is a fact—has nothing to do with the proper method or system of taxation. The wisest expenditure of money won't prove that we had tax system is good. The most foolish expenditure of money can't prove that a good tax system is bad. Possibly it is not a fact that we are spending too much money, but that we are not getting a dollar's worth of public good for every dollar we spend.

2. It is not true that dead land is of no value if someone is willing to buy it and own it. It certainly isn't true if the land is increasing in value every year, and where is the Clackamas county land that is assessed and is not increasing in value?

3. Land that is "of no value except for the timber growing upon it" is worth something for more than timber to grow on. It wouldn't be good business to see to grow timber on fruit land and city blocks. Natural growth timber is a part of the "land value," just as coal is.

4. But whether we have one state commission or a hundred commissions, that has nothing to do with the system of taxation.

5. You're wrong about Oregon farmers paying their share of the burden of taxation. They are paying from two to four times their share, and they will keep on carrying that load as long as they are taxed on their labor, their improvements and personal property.

6. Mr. Hackett says "When a rich man is taxed so that he has to give up his holdings, rest assured that the poor homesteader has surrendered long ago." How so? The eastern capitalist's holdings are for speculation only. Increasing valuation pays them good interest. They don't improve or till. The homesteader will make the land produce. But if you think single tax will hurt the poor man, then let us do it. Here are a few local instances I find as a matter of record: S. G. Miller is a small home owner at Gladstone. He has two lots assessed \$300 in 1910, with improvements assessed \$400; total assessment \$700. His tax for 1910 was \$14. Under single tax his tax would have been \$8.50. He would not have paid any tax on his \$400 improvements. How much does it hurt a home owner to have his tax reduced from \$14 to \$8.50?

C. A. and Grace Baxter of Gladstone, owned two lots that were assessed \$200 in 1910, and they had \$325 of improvements and personal property; total assessment \$525; total tax paid, \$10.40. Under single tax they would not have been taxed on their \$325 of improvements and personal property, and their tax on \$200 worth of lots would have been \$5.00. How much does it ruin a home owner to

UP THE WRONG TREE.

Two weeks ago the Courier made comparisons between the Willamette valley and Crook county, and suggested that any man who had ever lived at Bend should be for a reform. The comparison was further extended to "some eastern and central Oregon towns."

Just how he figured I don't know, but Editor Cheney of the Chieflain Interpreneur, who is out of Walla Walla county, thought this comparison included that county, and the way he went after old Clackamas in a "get back" would put our thermometer up several degrees. But he lets the Courier editor out in this way, and he is forgiven.

However, we'll not censure Editor Brown. He's one of the few country editors with ideas and the nerve to express them. Nothing of the "me too" order about him. All he needs is a couple of months in beautiful Walla Walla next summer, and up it will rain, enervated constitution and broadness in his mind, and he would go home a stronger and wiser man.

And now if Editor Cheney will look up the comparison he will find it was Crook county and not Walla Walla county he was making a pretty big ado about nothing.

WHO ARE DEMOCRATS?

We find in Mr. Bryan's paper the following: "When trust magnates say that competition cannot be restored between corporations they insist Socialism. If the doctrine thus contended for is ever accepted by the public, then the only remaining question will be whether profits of monopoly shall be enjoyed by a few favored individuals or by the public. The Democratic party is opposed to Socialism, and it therefore, stands for a restoration of competition. It may be difficult to 'unscramble eggs,' as Mr. Morgan suggests, but it is better to separate the members of a trust than to endure either private monopoly or its legitimate offspring—Socialism."—Bryan's Commonwealth.

Mr. Taft also said virtually the same thing. So we have both dominant parties agreed. But ten or twelve years ago when the Socialist press and agitators welcomed the trust as a forerunner of Socialism, they got the big game or horse laugh, but now the old party politicians have to acknowledge we were right once at least. Now it is a fact, as Bryan, Taft, La Follette and "Ted" say: "Back to competition, accept the trust or go forward to Socialism."

What are you going to do about it, Mr. Voter? If back, how far? To the jungle? Stand still and let a few big fish swallow us up, or go forward to the co-operative commonwealth—a real democracy.

It is up to you, Mr. Democrat and Republican working male, whether you stand for Bryan, Ted, back to the jungle or the trust, or for Polly and the children.

This is the issue, the whole issue and nothing but the issue, so help yourself.

Sav, who are the Democrats, anyway? Yours for a pure democracy, W. W. MYERS.

CUT OUT THE RED FLAG.

When Assemblyman Merrill, the first Socialist ever elected to the New York legislature, was escorted to his chair, the delegation carried a red flag.

It is such pretty little demonstrations as this that show Socialism more harm than all the anti-Socialistic can print. It gives the cause the scent of anarchy and it makes level-headed men fear the future.

The old stars and stripes that Americans have given their lives for and draped with their blood is flag enough to cover any political party in this country, and why American Socialists should permit the red rag to be used on such occasions is what gets me.

Raising the price of shoes fifty cents a pair will do more harm to the Republican party than all the Democratic speakers of the country.

President Taft dramatically exclaims: "Nothing but death can keep me out of the fight now." But there are other things that can keep him out of the fight.

Lon Payne, Republican old guard boss, says the Republican scrap is between the old guards and the blackguards.

Put the strongest and cleanest men on the Democratic state and county ticket this fall, and the voters will see that the Republicans won't walk off with everything.

The cold storage morgues are used for the purpose of cornering products and keeping prices up. A stringent law, compelling the date to be put on every cold storage product would stop this. The American farmers were paid six billion dollars for last year's egg production, while the American consumers had to pay the middle service thirteen billions.

In filling a petition of candidacy at Salem, Senator Bourne gives out these objects which he will work for: A system of direct legislation, popular election of senators, removals, police corporation control, exclusion of coal labor, non-partisan tariff commission, liberal appropriations for river and harbor improvements, free coal, enforcement of pure food laws, efficiency in government, national good roads legislation.

Washington Territory raised a regiment of union infantry volunteers. Oregon raised an infantry and cavalry regiment, Idaho raised a troop of rangers and California raised for the union service infantry and cavalry regiments and a battalion of "native cavalry," the last mostly Spanish-Americans. All these troops did good service in keeping the old emigrant trails free from hostile Indians, who looted upon the immigrant wagon trains as their lawful prey.

New Mexico Territory, of which at that time Arizona composed the western portion, had joined the southern confederacy. The "Five Civilized Tribes" of the Indian Territory, the Cherokees, Creek, Chickasaws, Choctaws and Seminoles, had also seceded. Had the secession element prevailed in Washington, Oregon and California, there would have been a formidable chain of country in the new confederacy, extending from the northern boundary of Washington down to the Rio Grande, and thence along the gulf to the south side of the Potomac. The failure of the Pacific slope to connect is one of the great "ifs of history."

The News says there are 1000 idle men in Portland. This condition is not because Portland is in bad shape—quite the contrary. That city is growing by leaps and bounds, and the whole coast country is in good shape. The trouble is simply that there are far too many men for the amount of jobs—an unnatural condition brought on by the boom stories, wage scales and splendid climate of this much-advertised Northwest.

The weak spot with eastern advertising is that it brings Oregon too many work hunters and too few work makers, and the work hunters fill the cities while the rich land sections settle up slowly.

Oregon should change its methods of advertising. It should reach out for men who have money equal to make a start, and it should warn the job hunters to stay away. We have too few of the former and an overload of the latter.

QUESTIONS FOR HICINBOTHAM.

210 E. 25 St., Portland.

Editor Courier: If it is possible for George Hicinchbotham to discuss a public question on its merits, I shall be glad to discuss single tax with him. Why does he waste his time and your space discussing me? Single tax is a public question in Oregon; I am not. In the Courier last week Mr. Hicinchbotham says of the proposed single tax bill:

"This law would hurt the poor home maker ten times as bad as it would the rich land holder because the rich land holders have plenty and don't feel it, but it would hit the poor man to the wall to start in with."

If Mr. Hicinchbotham will curb his misstatement until the "Single Tax Assessment and Tax Roll of Clackamas County for 1910" is published, he will find that he is shedding his tears over the wrong grave. After he sees that roll he won't feel so much like predicting ruin for the poor home maker.

Next he says: "I am just as much in favor of breaking up and going away with these large land holdings as any man in the state."

What does he mean by a "large land holding"? Is he speaking of "land area or of "land value"? If one man has rights in land for himself the value given to half an acre, five acres or ten thousand acres by population and industry, it's no business of ours whether he holds ten acres or ten thousand acres.

Clackamas county assessments for 1910 show the Molalla Land Company had 24,265 acres assessed \$7,040, or \$28.40 an acre. Did the Molalla Land Company create or produce that value? If it did, what right have we to break it up or do away with it? Lots 1 and 2 of Block 215 in Portland, owned by H. L. Pittock, were assessed \$88,000 in 1910 for the land alone. That is \$8.80 a square foot, or at the rate of \$483,328 an acre. Which is the greater land holding? Did Mr. Pittock's labor create the \$88,000 value of those two lots?

What does Mr. Hicinchbotham mean by large land holdings? Does he mean the 31,409 acres in Clackamas county, owned by T. D. and S. E. Collins and assessed \$407,445 in 1910? But the land alone of Block 215 in Portland, owned by H. L. Pittock, chief owner of the Oregonian, was assessed \$502,000 in 1910, and it would take 34,193 pieces of land as large as that Block 215 to make as much land as T. D. and S. E. Collins own in that one tract. The assessed value of the Pittock block of land was \$12,355 in a square foot in 1910, while the Collins tract was assessed \$14.70 an acre.

Mr. Hicinchbotham would put a direct tax on "large land holdings," so as to make the owners "let go." Would he make Mr. Pittock "let go" his Block 215, which is less than one acre in size, but greater in value than any land holding in Clackamas county except that of the Oregon and California Railway Company?

Is a vacant Oregon City lot worth \$500 a smaller land holding than 5 acres of Clackamas county land worth \$250? Is a 100-acre tract of wild Clackamas county land worth that as a larger holding than a 10-acre tract of wild land worth \$1,500 an acre?

Is the Oregon City water power, claimed by the Portland Railway, Light and Power Company and worth more than \$7,000,000 a smaller holding than the 89,370 acres owned in Clackamas county by the O. & C. Railway Co. and assessed \$1,105,555 in 1910. Which is the larger holding of personal property, a \$6 cord of wood or a \$20 gold piece?

Mr. Hicinchbotham is in the position of a juror who makes up his mind about a case before he hears the evidence. He doesn't understand what single tax is or means. "With all thy getting get understanding," said the wise man. Which is mighty good advice.

W. G. EGULESTON.

Here's the man who will raise the rate to run the Taft campaign this year—Fred W. Upham. He was first assistant to the "barrel" in 1908, and he was so successful he has been promoted this term. He is a member in close standing with the Busse machine of Chicago. He has a local monopoly in winter and ice trust in summer. On the side he has a lumber company, a railroad and a family group of banks and trust companies. And I have an idea this man has some little secret on the tax side that a Taft administration won't interfere with his combinations. You know it isn't natural for a man to raise a campaign fund to be used against him.

Dr. Leonard Riley of McMinnville College, who has returned from an eastern trip, declares that Woodrow Wilson will be the Democratic nominee. He says that if Taft is nominated the business and professional men will vote the Democratic ticket.

It's Roosevelt against Taft, with La Follette watching for the weak places.

PUT YOUR IDEAL TO WORK.

It is good to have an ideal. But—Ideals are nothing if they do not end up to the real. To be worth while they must lead you somewhere and you somewhere. This is the test: Try your ideal on. If it is good the results will be good. You can test the tree of idealism by its fruits.

An ideal is a picture in your mind of what is supremely to be desired. It is a vision of what ought to be. And it is an impulse to better things. An ideal is more than a dream.

If you only dream you are not a good idealist. If you dream long and hesitate you are not an idealist at all; you are merely a Micawber waiting for something to turn up. If you are a true idealist you will go out and turn something up.

A true ideal is a big idea that has worked its way down from your head into your heart. It beckons—and leads you to an objective. A true ideal has terminal facilities.

You want to do or be. Well—The ideal takes hold of you where you are and as you are and puts you in motion—and in the right direction it leads you to a goal.

Lincoln had a true ideal. It was given him by his wilderness mother, who, when dying, called the nine-year-old boy to her bedside and said: "I am going away, my boy, but I want you to remember that your mother wants you to be a good and a useful man." That ideal—goodness and usefulness—led Lincoln up to the heights.

Jefferson had an ideal—to weave the web of democracy into the warp of organic law. It took him also to the heights of greatness. Ideals are living issues, not mere longings.

And your ideal—is it good? Then harness it to your life forces in such a way that it will lead you to noble accomplishment.

Hold fast to it. Dream the dream, but—make the dream come true. Dream? Yes, but do!

Link your ideal to your will power. Then something must move, because you have linked God's power with yours.

SCOTT'S EMULSION

is the best and quickest way to perfect health. Women and girls who suffer are simply weak—weak all over.

Opium and alcoholic mixtures are worse than worthless, they aggravate the trouble and lower the standard of health.

strengthen the whole body, invigorates and builds up.

Be sure to get SCOTT'S—it's the Standard and always the best.

ALL DRUGGISTS

11-21



No More Cold Hands

A woman often does not notice what a cold day it is so long as she is bustling around the house. But when she sits down to her sewing and mending, she soon feels chilly.

It is then she needs a Perfection Smokeless Oil Heater. Its quick, glowing heat warms up a room in next to no time.

That is the beauty of a Perfection Smokeless Oil Heater. It is always ready for use; you can carry it wherever you please; and you light it only when you want it.

The Perfection Oil Heater is smokeless and odorless—a patented automatic device insures that. It is reliable, safe and economical—burns nine hours on one filling. Handsome, too—drums finished either in blue enamel or plain steel, with nickel trimmings.

Dealers everywhere or write for descriptive circular to any agency of Standard Oil Company Incorporated.

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